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Curriculum Vitae
Fall 2026

Lucas Belmudes

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Citizenship: Argentine and Italian citizen. F-1 U.S. student visa.

Major Fields of Concentration

International Macroeconomics, Banking and Finance

Education

Degree	Field	Institution	Year
PhD	Economics	University of Minnesota (expected)	2027
MA	Economics	University of Minnesota	2023
MA	Economics	Universidad Torcuato Di Tella	2023
BA	Economics	Universidad Torcuato Di Tella	2018

Dissertation

Title: "Essays on Sovereign Debt and Banking Crises."
Dissertation Advisor(s): Professor Manuel Amador, Professor Tim Kehoe
Expected Completion: Summer 2027

References

Reference Name	Email / Contact Info	Address
Professor Tim Kehoe	tkehoe@umn.edu	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Professor Manuel Amador	amador@umn.edu	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Dr. Illenin Kondo	kondo@illenin.com	Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, 90 Hennepin Avenue, Minneapolis, Minnesota, 55401
Dr. Andrea Raffo	andrea.raffo@mpls.frb.org	Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, 90 Hennepin Avenue, Minneapolis, Minnesota, 55401

Honors and Awards

2026 *Hutcheson-Lilly Dissertation Fellowship*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.

2025 *Runner-up, Supercomputing Exhibition*, Minnesota Supercomputing Institute. Recognized for the high-performance computational methods used in "Domestic vs. Foreign Law: Portfolio Dynamics of Sovereign Debt."

2024 *Runner-up, Third-Year Paper Competition*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Departmental distinction for "Transparency in Debt Crises."

2023 *Nominee, Princeton Initiative*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Departmental nominee to a program convening Ph.D. students working at the intersection of macroeconomics and finance.

2022 *Silverman Fellowship*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Awarded for strong first-year performance in the Economics Ph.D. program.

2022 *Dr. Harald Uhlig Award*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota. Recognizing aptitude in macroeconomics among first-year students.

2021 *Sims Fellowship*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.

Research Experience

2023–2026 *Research Analyst*, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, Minnesota, USA. With Andrea Raffo: effects of tariffs on the U.S. economy and on optimal interest rates, using models of international trade and monetary policy; quantitative modeling and dataset analysis in MATLAB, Stata, and Python.

2026 *Summer Intern*, General Directorate of Financial Stability (DGEF), Banco de México, Mexico City. Extended and presented the empirical section of my job market paper to DGEF staff.

2019–2021 *Research Assistant (remote)*, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, Rome, Italy. With Juan Passadore: sovereign debt models on credit and liquidity risk; high-performance computation in C++/CUDA/OpenMP and databases in Stata and Python.

Teaching Experience

2023 *Instructor*, Summer Math Camp (graduate-level course), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.

2022–2023 *Teaching Assistant*, Microeconomic Theory (graduate-level course), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.

2019 *Teaching Assistant*, Asset Pricing (graduate-level course), Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, Rome, Italy (Remote).

2018–2021 *Teaching Assistant*, Undergraduate courses (Economic Development: 2019–2021; Topics in Macroeconomics: 2018–2020; Principles of Economics: 2018), Universidad Torcuato Di Tella, Buenos Aires, Argentina.

Working Papers

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Domestic vs. Foreign Law: Portfolio Dynamics of Sovereign Debt" **(Job Market Paper)**

Presented by me: Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory (SAET) (Ischia, 2025); 6th Biennial Conference on Financial Stability (Mexico City, 2025); Banco de México internal seminars (2026); HHEI Alumni Conference (2026); UMN–UW Workshop (2024, 2026).

Presented by co-author: Brazilian Econometrics Meeting (Natal, 2024).

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Bank Runs and Market Value Solvency"

Presented by co-author: Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory (SAET) (Rio de Janeiro, 2026); UMN–UW Workshop (2026); HHEI Alumni Conference (2026).

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Transparency in Debt Crises" (Revise and resubmit, Journal of International Economics)

Presented by co-author: Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory (SAET) (Santiago, 2024); UMN–UW Workshop; Midwest Macro (2026).

Computer Skills

C++, CUDA, Python, MATLAB, Stata, LaTeX

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent), Italian (elementary)

Abstract(s)

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Domestic vs. Foreign Law: Portfolio Dynamics of Sovereign Debt" **(Job Market Paper)**

Emerging-market governments borrow both under their own law and under foreign law. If the government defaults, the governing law determines whether domestic or foreign courts settle disputes, and so how much investors recover. For twelve governments, we document that all borrow under both laws, that each issues its foreign-law debt at longer duration, and that issuing under foreign law costs a fee proportional to the money raised and independent of maturity. We show that the yield gap between a government's bonds under the two laws widens with the probability of default. We build a quantitative model of sovereign default in which the government cannot commit to repay or to limit its future borrowing. Through the lens of the model, the widening gap implies that investors expect to recover more on foreign-law debt. The government still borrows under domestic law because shorter debt is less exposed to dilution. The fee keeps it from issuing shorter foreign-law debt, which would recover more and be less exposed to dilution. Calibrated to Colombia, the model implies recoveries of 47 percent under foreign law and 40 percent under domestic law. Removing the fee raises welfare by 12 percent of the gain the model generates when aggregate risk and default costs are eliminated, mostly through changes in how the government borrows and defaults.

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Bank Runs and Market Value Solvency"

Interest rate hikes lower long-duration government bond prices. Yet capital requirements do not take that into account and treat bonds as risk-free regardless of their maturity. This was a determining factor during the 2023 regional banking crisis. We study a version of capital requirements that assign positive risk weights to long-bond holdings and uninsured deposits in a dynamic model in which banks choose dividends and a portfolio of short and long bonds. Long bonds hedge fluctuations of deposit spreads while depositors stay in the bank, but make banks exposed to runs when rates rise. Uninsured depositors play a coordination game that makes runs likely when banks are poorly capitalized. Deposit insurance is financed by taxes on surviving banks, and affects depositors' payoffs, changing their incentives to run. We use U.S. Call Reports for 2010–2025 to calibrate the model and match the cross-sectional demand for long-bond holdings. We then evaluate a capital requirement that imposes a floor on banks' capitalization, based on their uninsured deposits. Along the observed rate path, a floor of 30% of uninsured deposits reduces deposits at failing banks by 15%. For at least half of the rate paths, however, the same rule increases deposits at failing banks, because it imposes losses after rates fall.

Belmudes, Lucas; Mendes, Angelo. "Transparency in Debt Crises" (Revise and resubmit, Journal of International Economics)

We study a sovereign's choice of whether to disclose information about its repayment capacity to international lenders in a 3-period Eaton and Gersovitz (1981) environment. Under full disclosure, debt is priced at actuarially fair rates for each type; under non-disclosure, a pooling equilibrium generates cross-subsidization across types. We show that non-disclosure is preferred when the probability of being the low type is small: the adverse selection discount the high type bears under pooling is then small, making opacity relatively cheap. Moreover, non-disclosure is preferred when deadweight losses from default are small: the insurance value of pooling then dominates the pricing gains from transparency. Two pieces of evidence support the framework. Mexico's pre-1995 reserve-disclosure regime illustrates a durable, pre-committed disclosure rule consistent with the model. Using IMF Data Standards Initiatives, we document that no country has ever moved to a lower transparency tier, that countries facing higher recession risk are more often observed to adopt transparency tiers, an association consistent with the model's threshold comparative static, and that early adopters exhibit, for two of the three tier margins, more dispersed residualized issuances than eligible non-adopters, in a direction consistent with the model.